

# MESHTASTIC TO MESHCORE



# NASH MESH

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Personal thoughts from Stuart A Wilson

“That’s crazy!” I exclaimed while watching the live Meshcore map at the NashMesh meetup on April 15th, 2026. At the time, most of us had recently transitioned to medium-fast on Meshtastic. While a few community members were early adopters of Meshcore, many of us—myself included—had recently contributed to the local infrastructure fund to expand Meshtastic. Although Meshtastic was performing adequately, many users found its performance inconsistent. We attributed this to a lack of infrastructure, believing that additional nodes would resolve the issue. However, that perspective shifted during the meetup. When we saw the live map displaying connections from East Tennessee to the East Coast, the advantages of Meshcore were clear. I returned home late that evening and immediately flashed my two portable nodes to Meshcore.

I knew this would be the next wave for the NashMesh community, and I wanted to be prepared. That weekend, I converted my home-based solar repeater to Meshcore. I saw a noticeable difference. It was a night-and-day difference for me. I went from occasionally getting messages out to reliably having conversations. Looking at my stats on my repeater showed a clear rise in traffic as well. My repeater’s daily traffic saw a dramatic increase, climbing from a daily average of 2–15 packets to 43–50, and then jumping to approximately 370. Most recently, following the deployment at Short Mountain, we hit a new peak of nearly 914 packets in a single day. I was not alone in the decision to start changing over hardware; there was a significant, rapid transition to Meshcore. The Meshcore channel on the NashMesh Discord surged from a few messages per day to several per hour. We expanded our logging capabilities from Meshtastic to include Meshcore. Meshcore nodes actually outnumbered Meshtastic devices for the first time, and as the infrastructure grew, Meshcore’s reliability became increasingly evident to the community.



During this period, the NashMesh community conducted a survey to evaluate member experiences and gauge interest in directing infrastructure funds toward Meshcore rather than Meshtastic. The survey received 50 responses from participants with varying levels of experience. When asked which platform the group should prioritize, 63.3% of respondents favored Meshcore, while only 12.2% supported Meshtastic, and 24.5% expressed no preference. The survey also revealed that 64% of users had utilized both platforms, providing a solid basis for comparison. Furthermore, Meshcore significantly outperformed Meshtastic in reliability ratings; it received 16 'excellent' votes compared to just three for Meshtastic. Many respondents specifically noted that Meshtastic's performance felt unpredictable, a "roll of the dice". With 64% of users operating their devices daily, these insights reflect the perspectives of dedicated, long-term network users.



The recently completed Short Mountain Node. Photo From Brandon Sasser / W4SFD

While Meshcore is a significant advancement, it is not without its challenges. We encountered initial growing pains similar to those we experienced with Meshtastic. Although deployment took time, we successfully shifted our user base and infrastructure from Meshtastic to Meshcore within a month. New infrastructure, including Love Circle, Music Mountain, and the recently completed Short Mountain repeater, is rapidly expanding our reach eastward. Under optimal conditions, we are already achieving intermittent connectivity with Asheville, North Carolina. While my node has detected advertisements from the East Coast, establishing consistent, regular communication remains a work in progress. Nashville's challenging topography makes it difficult to deliver signals into specific dead zones, though I am optimistic that as our infrastructure and node density increase, coverage will expand.

Witnessing the rapid growth of our community is truly exciting. Our survey revealed that 28% of our members are recent additions to the NashMesh community, and that these newer members are looking for more comprehensive documentation. I am currently developing guides covering basic builds and flashing procedures, which I hope to release within the next month or two. As I develop these materials alongside my professional responsibilities, my availability is limited; however, I am committed to supporting our community's continued expansion. By empowering more community members with a clear understanding of these processes, we can streamline onboarding for future newcomers.

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